

SentinelWire™ Wireshark Profile Builder (make_ws_profile.bat) — README & Instructions Manual

What this file does

make_ws_profile.bat is the interactive “Profile Builder” launcher for SentinelWire. When you run it, it prompts you for four environment-specific values:

- **Your IP** (your workstation IP)
- **Router IP** (default gateway IP)
- **Your MAC** (your workstation MAC address)
- **Router MAC** (default gateway MAC address)

These values are intended to be used to generate **personalized, router-aware Wireshark profiles** (display filters, coloring rules, etc.) so analysts can triage faster and pivot cleanly into specialized profiles.

Important: The current version of the .bat you shared **collects inputs and then exits** (“Profiles ready.”). It does **not yet** write these values into Wireshark profiles/templates by itself. This README explains how to run it correctly and what the inputs should look like.

Requirements

- **Windows** (CMD .bat execution)
- **Wireshark installed** (recommended, for using the resulting profiles)
- Ability to identify:
 - Your **local IP**
 - Your **router/default gateway IP**
 - Your **MAC address**
 - Your router’s **MAC address** (usually via ARP table)

How to run

1. Place make_ws_profile.bat in your SentinelWire project folder (or double-click it from File Explorer).
2. Run it:
 - **Option A:** Double-click make_ws_profile.bat
 - **Option B:** From Command Prompt:

- cd path\to\SentinelWire
 - make_ws_profile.bat
3. Answer prompts in order:
 1. Your IP:
 2. Router IP:
 3. Your MAC:
 4. Router MAC:
 4. You'll see: **"Profiles ready."** then press any key to close.

Input format rules (very important)

1) Your IP / Router IP

Use standard IPv4 format:

-  192.168.1.25
-  10.0.0.12
-  192.168.1.25/24 (don't include CIDR)
-  http://192.168.1.1 (no protocol text)

2) Your MAC / Router MAC

Use a consistent MAC format. Most tools output either:

- Colon-separated: aa:bb:cc:dd:ee:ff
- Hyphen-separated: AA-BB-CC-DD-EE-FF

This script accepts what you type, so **be consistent**. Recommended:

-  AA:BB:CC:DD:EE:FF (uppercase, colon-separated)

Avoid:

-  Extra spaces
-  Mixed separators (e.g., AA-BB:CC-DD:EE-FF)

How to find the correct values (quick methods)

Find Your IP + Router IP

Open **Command Prompt** and run:

ipconfig

- **Your IP** = “IPv4 Address”
- **Router IP** = “Default Gateway”

Find Your MAC

In the same ipconfig output:

- **Your MAC** = “Physical Address”

Find Router MAC (Gateway MAC)

Run:

arp -a

Find the line matching your **Router IP** (Default Gateway). The MAC shown there is your **Router MAC**.

Example run (copyable)

If your environment is:

- Your IP: 192.168.1.25
- Router IP: 192.168.1.1
- Your MAC: F0:1F:AF:12:34:56
- Router MAC: A4:B1:C1:AA:BB:CC

Then enter exactly those when prompted.

Expected behavior

After you enter the four values, you’ll see:

- Profiles ready.
- Then the window waits at pause until you press a key.

Troubleshooting

“arp -a” doesn’t show router MAC

- Make sure you’ve communicated with the router first (e.g., open a webpage, or ping 192.168.1.1), then run arp -a again.

Values seem wrong (multiple adapters/VPN)

- If you have VPNs / multiple network adapters, ipconfig may list several interfaces.
- Use the adapter that corresponds to your active network (Wi-Fi/Ethernet you're actually capturing on).

The script says "Profiles ready" but nothing changed

- That's expected with the current .bat you shared: it **does not yet generate/copy/update profiles**. It only collects the inputs interactively.